

every month. They really want those who carry a balance and those who they can nickel and dime with fees until death do they part. It would not be so bad if the fees were only nickels and dimes, but the late fees, and the over-limit fees, and the fees simply for having the privilege to carry a credit card, can be \$50, \$75, or even \$100 a pop.

For the person barely able to make their monthly payment, like Ed and Sue, and many other Americans who fall into this pool, the endless vicious cycle of fees keeps them paying, and playing catch up, until they die. The greedy bankers and lenders are fully aware of this, and this is exactly the type of borrower that has become the flesh of the credit lending business, and the creditors take their pound of flesh every month. When the consumer lenders look at such credit reports and credit scores, they don't see a bad credit risk – they see *dollar signs*.

Who Is a Deadbeat?

In a documentary that aired on PBS called *Secret History of the Credit Card*, author and actor, and former host of *Win Ben Stein's Money*, Ben Stein shows his four-inch stack of credit cards that he carries as he travels around the world. He claims the wallet that he carries in his

Are the
credit card
companies
calling you a
“deadbeat”?

suit jacket pocket is so thick, due to all those cards, that it gives him the appearance of having a third breast. Ben uses his credit cards, charging thousands of dollars every month. A rich man, spending lots and lots of money on credit – that is a banker's dream, right? Wrong. Ben pays off his balances in their entirety each and every month, and he pays on time. He says the credit card industry hates people like him. Verifying his claim, Ben ran into a high school acquaintance who works for a major credit card company and this man specifically stated, “We hate people like you. We call you the deadbeats.”

How backwards is that? Doing what is right and what is responsible, and being dubbed by the insiders as a deadbeat for it. Talk about slanderous. That only shows how twisted the consumer lending industry has become and how inflated their sense of entitlement has become as